ALEF · Memory chain · 27 letters you will not forget

1 Alef

א



uh-oh

אַבָּא father

2 Bet

ב



ball

בַּיִת house

3 Gimel

ג

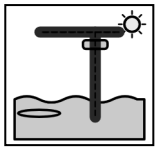


grumpy

גָּמָל camel

4 Dalet

ד



dive

דֶּלֶת door

5 He

ה



hut

הַר mountain

6 Vav

ו

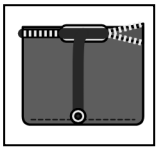


vine

וָו hook

7 Zayin

ז



zipper

זָהָב gold

8 Chet

ח



loch

חָלָב milk

S differ: see note 8

9 Tet

ט



tea

טֶלֶפוֹן telephone

10 Yod

י



yo-yo

יָד arm

11 Kaf

כ



cup

כַּף palm

12 Lamed

ל



lamp

לֶחֶם bread

13 Mem

מ



mailbox

מַיִם water

14 Nun

נ

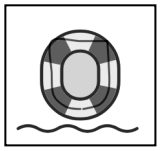


nap

נֵר candle

15 Samekh

ס



swim ring

סֵפֶר book

16 Ayin

ע



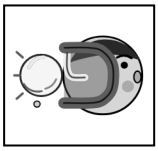
eye

עַיִן eye

S differ: see note 16

17 Pe

פ

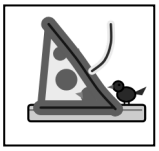


pop

פֶּה mouth

18 Tsadi

צ



pizza

צִפּוֹר bird

19 Qof

ק



kite

קַו line

20 Resh

ר



round

רֹאשׁ head

I S A differ: see note 20

21 Shin

ש



shortcake

שָׁלוֹם peace

22 Tav

ת

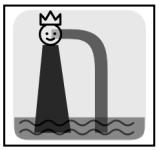


table

תִּינוֹק baby

23 Final Kaf (final form)

ך



loch

מֶלֶךְ king

24 Final Mem (final form)

ם



mom

יָם sea

25 Final Nun (final form)

ן

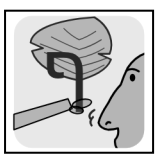


nail

אֶבֶן stone

26 Final Pe (final form)

ף



feather

אַף nose

27 Final Tsadi (final form)

ץ



nuts

עֵץ tree

How to read a cell. Thick-framed box: the letter. Framed picture: what the letter turns into. Bold word: the hook, a sound you already know. Under it: a Hebrew word that starts with or contains the letter, and what it means. ▭ A double border marks the five final forms (sofit), used only at the end of a word. A small line with **I S A** appears only where the traditions say the letter differently.

Notes where the traditions differ.

8 Chet. S pharyngeal [ħ], a throat sound (the ch of Bach / loch is the Israeli merged value).

16 Ayin. S pharyngeal [ʕ] (Western Sephardim [ŋ]); silent in Israeli and Ashkenazi.

20 Resh. I Real sound: back-of-the-throat r (like French or German r), not the English r · **S** Real sound: front r, rolled or tapped (like Spanish r) · **A** Real sound: r varies by regional dialect: front (alveolar) or back-of-the-throat (uvular)

Three ways to say it. I Israeli: everyday modern Hebrew (the default here). **S** Sephardi, as the app's setting: Israeli-style vowels said with English-speaking habits. **A** Ashkenazi: the traditional siddur reading, for example Shabbos for Shabbat. Pick one and keep to it. The picture hooks use the Israeli sound.